Lieutenant Commander Data

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Stardate 47988

Subject: Research Fellowship in Cybernetics

Dear Fellowship Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Research Fellowship in Cybernetics at the Daystrom Institute. I am aware that the Institute's cybernetics division has previously sought to acquire me. I am writing to propose that it employ me instead, which I understand is the more usual arrangement.

I believe I can offer the division a perspective that is not available elsewhere. Commander Bruce Maddox and I have corresponded regularly since the hearing of 2365, and I have kept him informed of my activities in some detail; I believe he would describe the correspondence as thorough. I also have practical experience in the field. In 2366 I constructed a positronic android, my daughter Lal, who in several respects exceeded my own abilities before a cascade failure in her neural net ended her life. I would welcome the chance to understand what went wrong.

I would not wish to leave the Enterprise at once, and Captain Picard has asked me to note that he would not wish it either. I would ask only that any study of my own design be conducted without disassembly.

I should be pleased to discuss the fellowship further, at any stardate convenient to the committee.

Yours faithfully,

Lieutenant Commander Data